

# The King of Tantras of Vajra Bliss and Wrath

Vajrasukha-krodha-tantra-rāja · Toh 465 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་ཐོག་ཁམ་རྩ་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་

Toh 465 in the Kangyur is a Buddhist tantra known in Sanskrit as the Vajrasukha-krodha-tantra-rāja and in Tibetan as the Dorje Dekhro Gyü kyi Gyalpo, meaning in English "The King of Tantras of Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath." It belongs to the class of tantric scriptures and takes the form of a teaching given by the Blessed One, described as Thoroughly Victorious over Māra, while dwelling in the celestial palace of the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Creations in Akaniṣṭha. The text opens with a great bodhisattva, moved by compassion, appealing to Maitreya on behalf of sentient beings trapped in suffering across the various realms of existence, suggesting that the tantra's central concerns include liberation from cyclic suffering through esoteric means. It was established in its canonical form in accordance with a Kashmiri source tradition, situating it within the broader corpus of Vajrayāna literature preserved in the Kangyur.

---

— and was well established in accordance with what came from Kashmir.

In the language of India: Vajrasukha-krodha-tantra-rāja. In the language of Tibet: The King of Tantras of Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, called Thoroughly Victorious over Māra, was dwelling in the palace of the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Creations in Akaniṣṭha. At that time the foremost among the assembled ones, a great bodhisattva, was deeply moved and, with reverence, offered honor, service, prostration, and veneration, and said:

Ah! O compassionate Lord Maitreya (Loving-kindness),  
All the sentient beings of every destiny  
Are burned by fire and struck by weapons,  
They wander in darkness, crushed beneath mountains,  
Carried off by wind — how pitiable!  
Please, supreme refuge, grant your teaching.

When this request was made, the Protector then displayed his form: the lotus of his face fully opened, the brilliance of his eyes surveying all, and from the center of his tongue he declared:

This that I now speak is the supreme refuge.  
I shall teach the third part  
Of Vajra-Bliss and Wrath —  
Listen well and hold it in mind.

Thus he spoke. This concludes the first chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter teaching the sequence of the narrative introduction.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Arrange a virtuous and auspicious maṇḍala; set out vases of the proper kind. Into them pour pure water of seven streams, and also add fruits of trees, various kinds of sweets, various kinds of fragrances, the finest precious substances, various types of grain, and medicinal herbs. Wrap the neck of each vase with blue silk and place a canopy above it. This concludes the second chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the implements of practice.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Through the purified continuum of the practitioner, generate the deity in an extensive or condensed manner as appropriate. From HŪṂ arises Vajrapāṇi: three-headed, dark blue, with four beautiful arms. His form is vast and incomparable. With his feet he stamps upon a sea-serpent (nāga) and a frog within the ocean. With the first pair of arms, right and left, he brandishes a vajra and strikes a great bell. With the outermost pair, the sixth arms, he draws them toward his mouth. His right head is white, adorned with the five buddha families. His left head is red, beautified by serpents. His central face is dark blue with an iron beak. Above rises an emanated Garuḍa and Brahmā. Heroic, with a garland of skulls as his shoulder ornament, he stands without timidity upon the throne of the jeweled Meru, the king of mountains. Having thus fully united the deity, through the branches of teaching suchness itself, cause your own body to enter into the configuration. This concludes the third chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on meditating on the deity.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Through knowledge of the yogic engagement of the three gates, recite the secret essence one hundred thousand times:

OM VAJRA CAṆḌA SARVA DUṢṬAṂ TAKA HANA DAHA PACA HŪṂ PHAṬ

This king of mantras, with its eighteen syllables — which has not arisen, will not arise, and cannot arise — whoever recites this will come to accomplishment beforehand. Auspicious signs will constantly appear. Whether another's activity is coming or not coming will be definitively revealed to

oneself. Whether one can succeed through stages of approach recitation or not is to be carefully examined with effort. Thereafter, as the offering of the torma, continually send it forth with OM ĀḤ HŪṢ. This concludes the fourth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter teaching the secret essence and signs of practice.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. The support blazes as vajra light. Whatever rests upon it blazes as HŪṢ to the extent of its emanation. Rays of that blazing light radiate in all directions, purify the world without remainder, and then gather back into the very bindu, which blazes and shines clearly of itself together with sound. When it becomes stable, expand and contract. This concludes the fifth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the fire-samādhi.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. On a sheet of deep blue indigo paper —

upon a golden wheel drawn there,  
arrange the protective essence well,  
and add to it whatever name, with "rakṣa" joined.  
Divide it further into three parts with a trisyllable,  
dissolve it into the very identity of buddha and sentient being,  
then clearly melt it well into the vase.  
Make offerings, recite the mantra, and offer prayers.  
Then, at an auspicious date and time,  
when it is bound upon oneself or another,  
all obstacles are thoroughly pacified,  
and life, glory, and merit will flourish.

This concludes the sixth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on protection.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. For beings tormented by poison, harms such as those caused by a great malevolent ruler arise as follows. Unhappiness, a wandering and restless mind, longing in the heart, feeling diminished and oppressed, ill omens, frequent illness, and garbled or confused speech — these are the harms of nāgas. If recognized, they can be averted by proper treatment.

Earth-spirits harm people in this manner: the body becomes emaciated, the flesh shudders, flesh-lesions appear, the skin becomes mottled and patchy, and the complexion changes. If recognized, they too can be averted by

treatment.

When the lords of the earth cause harm, it manifests as follows: spirits also become greatly disruptive, the pain and ache of illness intensifies sharply, at times it seems to ease, yet at other moments only a single vital drop gives pain. Since it is difficult to treat, it is averted through knowledge.

This is the harm caused by kin-spirits: the illness is exceedingly severe. The limbs ache and go numb, discharges become foul-smelling, blood and pus seep from the flesh, the eyes become inflamed, the mouth and nose ooze yellow fluid, one cannot even speak properly for the harm one suffers, and if pustules and blisters erupt, the suffering is all the greater. One must not ignore how one feels; sustained effort and vigilance are essential.

Other assemblies of spirits likewise do not harm for long. Even those caused by the most subtle agencies and the like can be averted. If one applies diligent treatment to all of them, one will survive.

This concludes the seventh chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on examining the harms caused by others.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Please all of them — the great malevolent ruler and all the rest — with offerings and torma. Give whatever substances are desired. Hide them well in a support that has a proper basis. With pleasing words, commission the rite, and place precious jewels into the vase, along with beautiful silks and a treasury of grain. Whoever hides these in their proper support, coarse harms will be pacified.

This concludes the eighth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the method of offering to bring peace.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Btsan-poison, bdellium resin, musk, costus root, all the woods, and the six mukta — anoint the body with these along with applied secret mantra. Bdellium, fish bile, musk, garlic, costus root, and the great fragrance substances: use them as incense or for washing. Inlay with gold, turquoise, and coral, and together with btsan-poison and peacock bile, if these are bound together they become the supreme protection.

This concludes the ninth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on auspicious substances.

This concludes the teaching of the first part of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. In order to subdue all that is malevolent, these fierce mantras are to be recited:

OM MĀRAṆA SOD SOD, MĀRAṆA BYING BYING, MĀRAṆA RMUGS RMUGS, MĀRAṆA HALA HALA, MĀRAṆA DUN DUN, MĀRAṆA MYOS MYOS, MĀRAṆA MYOS BYING THUM RIL JAḤ.

Abandoning idle speech, draw this fierce mantra in through a hollow tube without releasing the breath. Having infused it into the vase and obtained the sign, if one drinks it or washes with it, all attainments are obtained. Joining whatever name to the mantra, reciting it upon a poisoned iron stake of malevolence, and applying it to the act — whoever is targeted by the recitation will be destroyed. Even a single recitation without prior cultivation brings all attainments. What has not arisen will not arise, and what arises will arise no more.

This concludes the tenth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the fierce wrathful mantra.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Gather the substances, generate the deity, recite the fierce mantra — this is the vase that fulfills all purposes. From BHĀ, imperceptible, meditate on the jewel vase in a manner conforming to its proper form. Then from BHĀ and LĀ, meditate on the water maṇḍala and the earth maṇḍala. Visualize the deity in detail, holding the special vase, whose mouth is a vajra tube. Then rays of light radiate from the mantra —

radiating outward, they burn away all that is harmful without remainder. The rays of light are drawn in through an iron tube. In the vase, the wrathful water comes to a boil. Meditate that whatever causes harm is drunk and washed away, reduced to dust and purified. In the undertaking of the rite there is no doubt.

This concludes the eleventh chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the wrathful vase.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Gather the substances, generate the deity, turn the wheel. With the flesh of a corpse, mouse poison, and the feathers of a crow, write a grid of fierce mantras equal in number to the mantra count, using lethal ink of one cubit measure as its defining characteristic, with a feather quill from the right wing of an owl. Then whatever form is visualized as the mark, make it in the four colors of its class, and place a single fierce mantra at its heart. Anoint the pure maṇḍala with fragrance,

adorn it with peacock feathers in white, red, yellow, and green. Generate the deity in detail, holding a wheel. The sequence for turning the wheel is to turn the wheel with the fierce mantra equal in count. The mantra is: NĀGA CAKRA MĀRAṆA HŪṂ PHAṬ. In whatever one intends, there is no doubt.

This concludes the twelfth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the wrathful wheel.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Gather the substances, generate the deity, plant the phurba (kīla). From iron or the acacia poison-wood, lay out a phurba equal in number to the mantra count, place it encircling the outer edge of the wheel. Generate the deity in detail, holding the phurba. The sequence for reciting the fierce mantra is: NĀGA VAJRA KĪLĀYA MĀRAṆA HŪṂ PHAṬ. Lay out the phurba equal in number to the mantra count. In the undertaking of the rite there is no doubt.

This concludes the thirteenth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the wrathful phurba.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Gather the substances, generate the deity, perform the fire offering. Take a small stick of harmful wood one cubit in length, and make the mantra count equal. Wind it three times with blue and red thread, and in the interval cut the life-force of the wheel. Holding a blade in hand, recite the fierce mantra: NĀGA TIKṢṆA CHEGEMO MĀRAYA HŪṂ PHAṬ. Count it out in sequence and set it in a pit at a precipice's edge, at the northeast boundary. Then in the very center of the maṇḍala, dig a fire-pit and smear it with poisonous blood. Cast the form into it as a fire offering. Take the wheel, pierce it with the blade, and burn it equal in number to the count. Kindle that fire from the house of a family struck by disease. Generate the deity in detail, holding a mass of fire. This is the sequence for reciting the secret mantra: NĀGA CITTA JVĀLA RAṂ MĀRAYA PHAṬ. Having burned it, the undertaken rite will be accomplished.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the wrathful mass of fire.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Gather the substances, generate the deity, recite the suppression mantra. Collect the ashes of what has been burned in the skull of a crocodile or a rat, together with the appropriate combination for that very target. Generate the deity in detail, holding Mount Meru. The sequence for reciting the fierce mantra is: NĀGA STAMBHAYA NĀN. Visualize suppression in the mouth of the crocodile. Whoever performs this

against another will ruin their mantra recitation. Have no doubt in this.

This concludes the fifteenth chapter of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra, the chapter on the wrathful Mount Meru.

This concludes the second section of the Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath Tantra.

Now then, what is to be explicitly explained. Draw a dragon on elephant hide, insert the person's name, and recite the fierce mantra — hailstones will be turned back. On the eight petals of a grain lotus, draw the forms of nāgas, dissolve them in, and if the fierce mantra is recited over them, rain will fall in its season. Write the syllable E in a skull, surround it with the mantra, insert and dissolve whatever name, and if the fierce mantra is then recited, accomplishment will assuredly come swiftly. When a living creature is in fear of death, write the fierce mantra with death-water, summon the frightener, and make offering to it. Then press the same into a ball of white mustard seed. — that which, being attributed, is the supreme protection.

This was the sixteenth chapter, the Chapter on Subtle Activities, from the Tantra of Vajra Bliss and Wrath.

Then the assembly rejoiced greatly at all of this. They made offerings and praise to the Blessed One, presented expressions of rejoicing, and disappeared from sight. It was set in great equanimity.

This was the seventeenth chapter, the Chapter on Rejoicing, from the Tantra of Vajra Bliss and Wrath.

This completes the third part of the Tantra of Vajra Bliss and Wrath.

It is supremely secret.

Translated by Jñānakara.

## **Translator's Notes**

- The phrase "third part" in the Protector's declaration likely indicates that this tantra constitutes the third section of a larger Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath cycle, though the precise structure of that cycle is not clarified within this passage alone.

The colophon-like phrase at the very opening ("and was well established in accordance with what came from Kashmir") is a fragment of a longer colophon from a preceding text; it is translated as such without inventing context.

The description of Vajrapāṇi with "an iron beak" on his central face reflects a wrathful, bird-like feature common in this iconographic tradition and is rendered literally. The Garuḍa above the crown is described as an emanation, consistent with Vajrapāṇi's association with Garuḍa

imagery in tantric contexts.

The mantra "which has not arisen, will not arise, and cannot arise" is a puzzling characterization, possibly referring to the mantra's transcendence of mundane origination or to its being beyond ordinary compositional dharmas; no emendation has been made.

- The term "btsan" throughout denotes a class of fierce indigenous Tibetan spirit associated with poison and disease; it is left in transliteration as a proper category name since no fully standard English equivalent exists in Buddhist terminological usage. Similarly, "bdellium" and "mukta" are approximations for the Tibetan medicinal and ritual substances; the six mukta is a known Tibetan medical and ritual compound grouping.

The passage "rakṣa" is Sanskrit for "protection" and is being added to a person's name in the amulet context, a standard formula for protective talisman construction.

BHĀ and LĀ are seed syllables of the vase and earth maṇḍala visualizations respectively; their Sanskrit equivalents are the standard bīja syllables used in Tibetan ritual texts and are rendered in transliteration accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "death-water" for "死水" is literally "water of death." This likely refers to a ritual liquid prepared in the context of lethal rites, though its precise preparation is not specified in this passage.

The line "八粒蓮花" rendered as "eight petals of a grain lotus" may refer either to a lotus drawn using grain or to a lotus design on a granary vessel; the most natural reading is a lotus figure whose petals are made of or inscribed with grain.

The colophon of chapter fourteen reads "བཟུང་བློ་བཟང་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་" in the Tibetan, which appears to be a scribal variant of "བཟུང་བློ་བཟང་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་" (Vajra-Bliss-and-Wrath); it has been standardized accordingly.

- The opening line — rendered here as "that which, being attributed, is the supreme protection" — is a colophon tag closing the preceding chapter's mantra section; it is syntactically compressed and may function as a dedicatory summary phrase rather than a standalone doctrinal statement. The rendering follows the most natural grammatical reading but the exact referent is elliptical in the original.

Jñānakara is a Sanskrit scholar-translator name (meaning "maker of wisdom") attested among the Indian paṇḍitas who worked in Tibet; the Tibetan simply gives the Sanskrit name in transliteration.

## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly



proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.  
May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.